

Cables and Accessories

USB cables were supplied with all the drives. In some systems, the power that the USB port supplies is insufficient to drive an external hard drive.

To remedy this, the Maxtor OneTouch III Mini Edition and Seagate ST9100801U2RK have a cable with two USB connectors to connect to two USB ports—one that carries data and the other that exclusively carries power.

Other Features

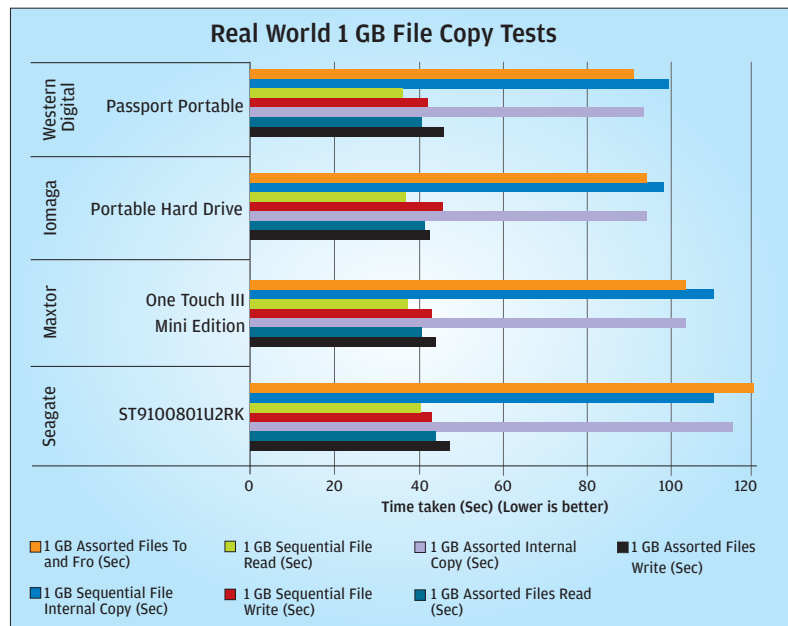
To solve the USB power problem in a way other than providing a two-port USB cable, all the drives except the WD Passport came with a power connector to which you can connect a power adapter.

When it comes to ruggedness, nothing beats the Seagate, which has a hard casing with an aluminium mesh on the side, which helps in ventilation.

The Maxtor OneTouch III also seemed to be durable. Thanks to the rubber jacket, it may even endure a “drop test.” We didn’t test this of course, not sure of what drive was inside, but it’s reassuring to the touch. The Iomega had a simple casing, which seemed the weakest.

The lightest of all the drives was the Iomega, which also has the smallest dimensions. The WD Passport is also sleek, and has a rubberised base.

The Maxtor OneTouch III Mini Edition has a backup button, meaning backups at just the touch of one button.



Performance

HD Tach RW

While there was not much variation in the random access time, the CPU utilisation of the Seagate drive was the lowest at just 3 per cent. The Iomega and Maxtor drives took up 8 per cent of CPU time. These CPU utilisation levels are considered normal, but anything above 15 per cent means something isn’t right.



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